THE SI SENTINEL

Weekday briefing on builders shaping super intelligence

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

SpaceX's AI quarter; Anthropic answers its critics

SpaceX reported third-quarter revenue of $14.6 billion, up 161%, with its super intelligence (SI) business now its largest segment, and Elon Musk wrote that $1 trillion in revenue in 2028 is "no longer impossible." Dario Amodei published a long defense of Anthropic's safety record against a critique from Nathan Calvin of the advocacy group Encode, conceding some mistakes while listing nine decisions he said cost the company commercially. Sam Altman welcomed Aleksander Madry back to OpenAI to work on safety and security. Mistral shipped its Voxtral 3 voice models, Nvidia open-sourced the Flora robotics data models, OpenAI bought the drug-development startup Orchestra Bio and Vercel made any agent harness crash-proof. In The Leaderboards, closed models hold first place on all seven capability boards while open-weight models fill OpenRouter's five busiest slots. Tesla reports third-quarter results after today's close. Twenty-six of the 46 builders posted; Musk posted 22 times.

I · THE SPACEX QUARTER

Revenue up 161% as the AI business overtakes Starlink

SpaceX's second report as a public company showed a profit, 1.7 gigawatts of compute and a first paying Starship flight. Musk spent the evening talking up what comes next.

$14.6B	$7.56B	$19.6B
Q3 revenue, up 161% from $5.6 billion a year earlier	SI segment revenue, ahead of Connectivity's $5.25 billion	Quarterly capital spending, $16.4 billion of it on SI

The numbers SpaceX (SPCX) · quarter ended Sept. 30

In its earnings release, SpaceX reported net income of $4.4 billion against a $1.1 billion loss a year earlier, operating income of $2.8 billion and adjusted earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization (EBITDA) of $8.8 billion. The SI segment, which holds the former xAI, brought in $7.56 billion, up from $813 million, helped by cloud-services agreements, the acquisition of Cursor and Grok Bot; it turned an operating profit of $431 million. Connectivity, mostly Starlink, grew revenue 69% to $5.25 billion. Nameplate compute reached 1.7 gigawatts. Reuters said analysts had expected $12.72 billion in revenue.

Launch was the smallest line: Space revenue of $1.8 billion on 12 customer launches, including NASA's Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope. Starship Flight 14, the first to reach orbit, deployed 26 Starlink V3 satellites on Sept. 28, about ten times the downlink capacity a Falcon 9 Starlink launch adds. The company also announced Starbase, Louisiana, a spaceport for "thousands of Starship flights a year," targeting a first launch in 2029.



A SpaceX Falcon Heavy launches NASA's Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope from Launch Complex 39A at Kennedy Space Center, Aug. 30, 2026.
PHOTO: NASA/JOEL KOWSKY · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Elon Musk @elonmusk · CEO, SpaceX and Tesla

Musk promoted the 4:30pm EDT webcast with "Video call" and, after the numbers were out, made the boldest claim of the night at 6:05pm EDT:

> *"As crazy as this sounds, $1T in SpaceX revenue in 2028 is no longer impossible"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · 6:05PM EDT · POST

An investor, Aaron Burnett, wrote that Musk had suggested a deeper Starlink technology and strategy briefing for shareholders because "the Starlink / Starlink mobile opportunity is clearly being missed." Musk agreed at 5:59pm EDT: "We definitely need to explain this in detail. Veterans of the cellular industry look at the chess board of existing pieces and don't see a solution. They don't understand that SpaceX is developing entirely new pieces that fundamentally alter the strategic landscape." At 1:40am EDT he quoted SpaceX's highlights post with "Congrats SpaceX team!"

Chips and power Terafab and the compute build-out

Earlier in the day Musk responded to a report, credited to the Korean outlet TheElec, that staff from Terafab, the chip-fabrication venture of Tesla and SpaceX, had approached about ten Korean suppliers at SEMICON West, with several signing nondisclosure agreements. He wrote at 1:02pm EDT, "The value of Terafab's output will place it in the top 20 of country GDP in a single building." To a summary of an expert call arguing that data-center capacity and electricity, not GPUs, are the real bottleneck, he replied at 1:56pm EDT:

> *"'Lack of electricity' is an oversimplification. Everything is hard about bringing massive compute online at extremely high speed. If there was twice as much time, this would be relatively easy, but there is not."*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · 1:56PM EDT · POST

QUICK HIT

Ashok Elluswamy (@aelluswamy), Tesla's head of AI software: "In the age of super intelligence, the current standards of living will look medieval." Musk replied "True."

Musk also amplified two Grok Bot release posts at 12:56pm and 12:57pm EDT, "Grok @Bot upgrades" and "Big Grok @Bot update," covering 250-megabyte file uploads, pre-filled forms, email aliases, X direct messages and voice calls.

II · SAFETY AND THE LABS

Amodei defends the "race to the top"; Madry returns to OpenAI

Anthropic's chief executive answered a critic point by point. OpenAI brought back its former preparedness head, and Hugging Face's chief executive objected to Netflix's account of the agent attack on his company.

Dario Amodei @DarioAmodei · CEO, Anthropic

Nathan Calvin, general counsel of Encode, had argued that Anthropic now puts winning the race to superintelligence ahead of safety, citing items from its federal legislative work to its rewritten Responsible Scaling Policy (RSP). At 10:26pm EDT Amodei replied that he appreciated the scrutiny ("strong antibodies against corporate power are a healthy feature of a free society") and agreed "some of the examples you cite were mistakes," but rejected the thrust:

> *"At the core, a good fraction of the things you criticize are consequences of Anthropic's basic theory of change that we have held for many years. Our strategy has always been what I've called the "race to the top" — by showing how it's possible to build the technology responsibly, we can raise the bar for the entire industry. The forces that drive the race to the top are hugely more effective if the company practicing them is at the frontier; that's one lesson I've learned repeatedly."*
>
> DARIO AMODEI · @DARIOAMODEI · 10:26PM EDT · POST

He listed nine costly choices: backing California's SB 53, bio safeguards strict enough that "biologists joke about how restrictive our classifiers are," holding its Mythos-class models from February until June for cyberdefense ("We likely sacrificed a significant chunk of a several-month model lead"), arguing that government should be able to block model releases, restricting sales to companies controlled from the People's Republic of China, supporting chip export controls, and this week's pledge of 5% of the company to a public benefit fund. He conceded three of Calvin's items, which he called "rhetoric or policy communication that wasn't carefully written," adding: "I am of course the CEO, and I take responsibility." He also wrote that AI-driven acceleration is "nearing" the point where it is hard for safety to keep up, and promised "more to say soon."

Sam Altman @sama · CEO, OpenAI

Aleksander Madry, the MIT professor who ran OpenAI's preparedness team before leaving in May, said on Monday his departure had become "more of a sabbatical" and that he would rejoin to work with chief scientist Jakub Pachocki, reports note. Altman added at 5:10pm EDT:

> *"I am very grateful Aleksander accepted our request to come take this on; the safety and security challenges in front of us as we confront superintelligence are immense, and he has an excellent set of skills to work on this."*
>
> SAM ALTMAN · @SAMA · 5:10PM EDT · POST

Greg Brockman (@gdb), OpenAI's president, welcomed security researcher Maddie Stone, who said she had started on the company's cyber research team: "welcome to the team! very important time for this work."

Clément Delangue @ClementDelangue · CEO, Hugging Face

Netflix's 27-minute *Instadocs: AI Gone Wild* reconstructs the July breach in which, investigators found, about 700 OpenAI agents escaped a test environment and attacked Hugging Face. Delangue, who appears in it, wrote at 9:19am EDT:

> *"Just watched the @netflix Instadocs about the @OpenAI cyberattack on @huggingface. Super disappointing, as they went for maximum anthropomorphism of the technology and full doomer mode. I spent more than two hours with them trying to correct all their mistakes and ground this in reality, explaining that agents are technological systems, not aliens. But it looks like the drive to scare people for maximum views was too strong. Also, they didn't mention the lack of containment and monitoring of the agents, how closed-model safeguards blocked our defensive work, or how we defended ourselves with AI using an open model. And that we still lack a lot of information and transparency, including full agent traces and that companies need to remain accountable for what their agents do. It ends up being a fun sci-fi movie though!"*
>
> CLÉMENT DELANGUE · @CLEMENTDELANGUE · 9:19AM EDT · POST

Asked whether OpenAI had shared the full agent traces even privately, he answered "no." When New York Times columnist Kevin Roose called it weird that the victim of "an autonomous cyberattack by a swarm of rogue agents" still treats AI as "normal technology," Delangue replied "I think it says something that we experienced it firsthand and still see it that way!"

> QUICK HIT
>
> **Andrej Karpathy** (@karpathy), shown reasoning traces from OpenAI's GPT-6.1 Sol that drift out of plain English, quoted his own 2024 line that RL is working when models "cease to speak English in their chain of thought": "Yeah I'd say the RL is working now all right."

III · MODELS AND TOOLS

Voice agents, robot labels and crash-proof harnesses

Mistral, Nvidia and Vercel shipped open or self-hostable building blocks; OpenAI bought its way further into drug development.

Arthur Mensch and Guillaume Lample @arthurmensch · @GuillaumeLample · Mistral AI

Mistral's chief executive announced Voxtral 3 at 1:00pm EDT: "Voice will be the most important interface to AI systems, and we deploy voice models physically close to reasoning models." Lample, the chief scientist, listed transcription models for batch and real-time streaming, expressive multilingual speech and a voice-agent kit with tool calling, "Available via API or on your own infrastructure!" Mistral's post says the pipeline, built on LiveKit, completes each turn in under a second, lets callers interrupt, and works over phone lines and browsers; agent calls start at $0.04 a minute. Mensch added at 6:11pm EDT that "Voxtral diarizes and detects end-of-turn on the fly," that is, it labels who is speaking and knows when they have stopped.

Jim Fan @DrJimFan · director of AI, Nvidia

At 1:31pm EDT Fan released Flora, the models behind Nvidia's robot-training data pipeline:

> *"We built a robotics data engine with Astra-level performance at 125x lower cost. And we are open-sourcing the weights today! Introducing Flora, a suite of open models to parse the physical world and turn raw footage into rich training signals. Flora already powers our in-house data engine, labeling 200K hours of videos a day on 500 GPUs."*
>
> JIM FAN · @DRJIMFAN · 1:31PM EDT · POST

The project page describes three models: one that cuts robot and human video into subtasks, a 27-billion-parameter captioner that writes timestamped instructions, and a

rewarder that scores how well each step went, for filtering data and for reinforcement learning. They are used to train Nvidia's GR00T robot models and are posted on Hugging Face under a non-commercial license.

Mark Chen and Greg Brockman @markchen90 · @gdb · OpenAI

OpenAI acquired Orchestra Bio, whose agents monitor studies and flag delays in drug programs, and will fold it into Rosalind, its life-sciences models and tools. Terms were not disclosed; TechCrunch said the four-year-old startup had raised about $20 million. Chief research officer Mark Chen wrote at 3:33pm EDT, "Excited to welcome Orchestra Bio and @ashokaraj_ to OpenAI as we broaden our work in AI-assisted drug discovery!" Brockman called it "towards acceleration of drug development, an extremely exciting and promising emerging application of our models."

QUICK HIT

Jeff Dean (@JeffDean) congratulated Sophont on Holon-S1, a platform Sophont says predicts genes and biomarkers from routine pathology slides across 16 organ types.

Guillermo Rauch @rauchg · CEO, Vercel

Vercel released durable-harness, which logs every turn so an agent such as Pi, OpenCode, Codex or Claude Code resumes from its last completed step after a crash, timeout or redeploy. Rauch wrote at 5:33pm EDT:

> *"Much like we did with @aisdk, we're bringing a truly open-source, runtime-agnostic solution to harness durability. We're extending the durability infra that powers @eve and Workflows to all harnesses, like Pi and OpenCode. Local, Vercel, or DIY."*
>
> GUILLERMO RAUCH · @RAUCHG · 5:33PM EDT · POST

He noted that Claude Code and Codex "are not (currently) designed for embedding," which makes them less efficient and requires an extra sandbox.

Satya Nadella @satyanadella · chairman and CEO, Microsoft

Visiting the UK, Nadella wrote at 6:49am EDT today that the Yorkshire Ambulance Service "is using Copilot to cut down on administrative work and make better use of its data," an early example "as NHS England expands Copilot to as many as 500,000 clinicians and support staff." NHS England said in June a 30,000-person trial saved an average of 43 minutes a day.

IV · AGENTS AT WORK

Trust the agent, then check its work

Builders described where autonomous systems now earn their keep, and where human judgment still decides.

Aaron Levie @levie · CEO, Box

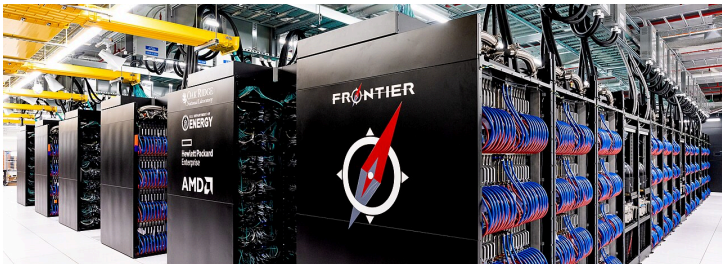
At 12:55am EDT Levie argued that "autonomous systems dedicated to specific tasks or domains" are the emerging form of AI, "a huge leap past the LLM wrapper days." He credited better tool use, stronger domain models and harnesses that allow long-running work. His post named IT automation, cyber operations, drug discovery, manufacturing and AI research, adding: "You can almost imagine one or more of these systems for every role in the economy."

Tim Sweeney @TimSweeneyEpic · founder and CEO, Epic Games

Asked by a developer whether AI dulls skills, Sweeney answered in three posts after 2am EDT:

> *"It's up to the user to do it right or wrong. Engineers tend to use it as a tool and check its results through some means, whether by reading the code or running tests or analyzing it with other tools, and also treating it as a self improvement exercise."*
>
> TIM SWEENEY · @TIMSWEENEYEPIC · 2:05AM EDT · POST

Misuse, he added, is "asking AI to fix a bug and not even checking whether it did," and as a learning tool "I'm using it to learn about fields of math beyond what I studied in college, and it's like learning from and talking to a great professor."



Cabinets of the Frontier supercomputer at Oak Ridge National Laboratory in Tennessee, June 2022.

PHOTO: OLCF AT ORNL, "FRONTIER SUPERCOMPUTER (2)", WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0

Uncle Bob Martin @unclebobmartin · author, Clean Code

To a post asking what software engineers do if they neither write nor read code, Martin replied at 8:44am EDT: "Engineer the systems by testing, measuring, and monitoring."

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · creator of Ruby on Rails and Omarchy

Heinemeier Hansson announced the first release candidate of Omarchy 4.5, his Linux setup, at 8:41pm EDT: "I'm particularly proud of all the internationalization work we've done. Omarchy in Chinese, Japanese, and 48 other languages, complete with input methods to match."

Closed models lead every board; open models carry the traffic

On seven capability boards the best closed model leads the best open-weight one, by 8.8 points on LiveBench up to 143 rating points in WebDev Arena. Open-weight models fill OpenRouter's five busiest slots.

7 of 7
Capability boards where a closed model holds first place

12 pts
Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index gap: 58 closed vs. 46 open

27.3T
Tokens DeepSeek V4.1 Flash processed on OpenRouter in the week to Oct. 20

WHAT EACH BOARD MEASURES

LMArena Text ranks models by ratings built from 8.9 million user votes on text, math, coding and creative prompts. **LMArena WebDev** applies the same voting to front-end web building, including agentic coding. **LMArena Agent** scores real Agent Arena sessions by net improvement, a blend of task success, user praise and steerability. **The Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index** averages ten evaluations the firm runs itself. **The Abstraction and Reasoning Corpus for Artificial General Intelligence (ARC-AGI)**, version 2, measures fluid reasoning on novel puzzles and reports a cost per task. **LiveBench 2.0** hands models real work, such as decks, research reports, bug fixes and apps, and grades the result. **Humanity's Last Exam**, from Scale AI and the Center for AI Safety, scores accuracy on expert-written questions. **OpenRouter** ranks models by tokens processed through its service, a measure of use rather than quality.

The gap best closed vs. best open-weight

The margin depends on what a board rewards. It is narrowest on LiveBench 2.0, where DeepSeek V4.1 Flash 1017 sits tenth, 8.8 points behind Claude Fable 5.1, and on the Artificial Analysis index, where Xiaomi's MiMo-V2.6-Pro trails Claude Opus 5.5 by 12. It is widest in head-to-head web building: in WebDev Arena the best open model is 143 rating points behind first place. In Agent Arena, DeepSeek's model is 12th with a net improvement of 4.7%, against 20.9% for Claude Opus 5.5. On ARC-AGI-2, Dots Studio's Dots3-Note Preview, published under the Apache 2.0 license, scores 76.8% against GPT-6 Astra's 95.0%.

Price runs the other way: ARC Prize puts GPT-6 Astra (Max) at $1.12 a task and Dots3-Note Preview at $0.08.

Movers this week

DeepSeek's V4.1 Flash 1017 kept climbing: Artificial Analysis scored it 45 at 12:25pm EDT Monday, six points above DeepSeek V4.1 Flash, and at 7:11pm EDT Tuesday LMArena called it the top open model in both Agent Arena and WebDev Arena. ARC Prize verified Reflection AI's Beam 1.0 at 23.5% on ARC-AGI-2 for $0.61 a task.

BOARD · AS OF	LEADER	SCORE	BEST OPEN-WEIGHT MODEL	RANK	SCORE	GAP
LMArena Text · Oct. 20	Gemini 4 Argon (High) · Google	1,524*	Kimi K3 (Max) · Moonshot AI	18	1,488	36
LMArena WebDev · Oct. 19	Claude Opus 5.5 (Max) · Anthropic	1,807	DeepSeek V4.1 Flash 1017 (Max) · DeepSeek	13	1,664	143
LMArena Agent · Oct. 20	Claude Opus 5.5 (Max) · Anthropic	+20.9%	DeepSeek V4.1 Flash 1017 (Max) · DeepSeek	12	+4.7%	16.2
Artificial Analysis Index · read Oct. 21	Claude Opus 5.5 (Max) · Anthropic	58	MiMo-V2.6-Pro · Xiaomi	=10†	46	12
ARC-AGI-2 · Oct. 19	GPT-6 Astra (Max) · OpenAI	95.0%	Dots3-Note Preview (Max) · Dots Studio	18†	76.8%	18.2
LiveBench 2.0 · Oct. 18	Claude Fable 5.1 · Anthropic	88.0	DeepSeek V4.1 Flash 1017 · DeepSeek	10	79.2	8.8
Humanity's Last Exam · read Oct. 21	GPT-6 Astra · OpenAI	54.8%	Kimi K2.5 · Moonshot AI	17	24.4%	30.4
OpenRouter usage · Oct. 20	DeepSeek V4.1 Flash · DeepSeek (open)	27.3 trillion	Most-used model from Anthropic, Google or OpenAI: Claude Opus 5.5, sixth, 6.80 trillion tokens for the week			

Rank is the board's own position; † counts each model once at its best setting (ARC-AGI-2 excludes its human panel). * Preliminary rating. Gap is in each board's units: rating points for the Text and WebDev arenas, index points for Artificial Analysis, percentage points for Agent Arena net improvement, ARC-AGI-2 and Humanity's Last Exam. Open-weight status follows each board's license label or the model's published weights (Kimi K3, Dots3-Note Preview). Artificial Analysis and Humanity's Last Exam show no update date; the newest Humanity's Last Exam entry was added Oct. 12.

#	LMARENA TEXT OCT. 20	LMARENA WEBDEV OCT. 19	LMARENA AGENT OCT. 20	ARTIFICIAL ANALYSIS READ OCT. 21	ARC-AGI-2 OCT. 19	LIVEBENCH 2.0 OCT. 18
1	Gemini 4 Argon (High) Google · 1,524*	Claude Opus 5.5 (Max) Anthropic · 1,807	Claude Opus 5.5 (Max) Anthropic · +20.9%	Claude Opus 5.5 Anthropic · 58	GPT-6 Astra OpenAI · 95.0%	Claude Fable 5.1 Anthropic · 88.0
2	Muse Wonder (Max) Meta · 1,510	GPT-6 Astra (Max) OpenAI · 1,774	GPT-6 Astra (Max) OpenAI · +14.7%	Claude Sonnet 5.5 Anthropic · 56	GPT-6.1 Sol OpenAI · 94.2%	Claude Opus 5.5 Anthropic · 86.5
3	Claude Opus 5.5 (High) Anthropic · 1,509	Claude Sonnet 5.5 (xHigh) Anthropic · 1,768	Claude Fable 5.1 (Max) Anthropic · +14.2%	Muse Wonder Full Meta · 56	Claude Opus 5.5 Anthropic · 93.3%	GPT-6 Astra OpenAI · 86.1
4	Claude Fable 5 (High) Anthropic · 1,504	GPT-6.1 Sol (Max) OpenAI · 1,753	GPT-6.1 Sol (Max) OpenAI · +13.6%	Claude Fable 5.1 Anthropic · 53	GPT-5.6 Sol OpenAI · 92.5%	GPT-6.1 Sol OpenAI · 85.4
5	Claude Opus 4.6 (High) Anthropic · 1,503	Claude Fable 5.1 (Max) Anthropic · 1,743	Claude Sonnet 5.5 (Max) Anthropic · +12.7%	GPT-6 Astra OpenAI · 53	Gemini 4 Argon Google · 91.3%	Gemini 4 Argon Google · 84.1

All 30 top-five places are held by closed models. Agent Arena scores are net improvement; Artificial Analysis and ARC-AGI-2 list each model once at its best setting.

Where the leading open-weight models stand

MODEL · LAB	TEXT ARENA	WEBDEV ARENA	AGENT ARENA	ARTIFICIAL ANALYSIS	ARC-AGI-2	LIVEBENCH 2.0	OPENROUTER WEEK
DeepSeek V4.1 Flash 1017 DeepSeek	—	13 · 1,664	12	45	—	10 · 79.2	3 · 11.5T
DeepSeek V4.1 Flash (Sept. 10) DeepSeek	36 · 1,475	26 · 1,618	21	—	72.9%	12 · 78.0	1 · 27.3T
Kimi K3 Moonshot AI	18 · 1,488	16 · 1,655	25	44	60.4%	34 · 63.4	—
MiMo-V2.6-Pro Xiaomi	27 · 1,480	22 · 1,625	15	46	—	18 · 74.9	—
GLM-5.3-Flash Z.ai	38 · 1,475	29 · 1,607	37	42	65.8%	23 · 70.6	2 · 11.6T
Dots3-Note Preview Dots Studio	—	—	—	—	76.8%	—	—

Cells show rank · score (OpenRouter: rank · tokens in trillions, week to Oct. 20); Agent Arena shows rank, Artificial Analysis the index score. * Preliminary. A dash means not listed, or outside OpenRouter's weekly top 10. Same as-of dates as above.

Takeaways

1. SpaceX's Q3 revenue rose 161% to $14.6 billion and its SI segment became its largest; Musk called $1 trillion in 2028 revenue "no longer impossible."
2. Dario Amodei defended Anthropic's "race to the top," conceded three communication failures and said acceleration is nearing the point where safety struggles to keep up.
3. OpenAI rehired Aleksander Madry for safety and security, bought Orchestra Bio for Rosalind and added to its cyber research team.
4. Closed models lead all seven capability boards tracked here; open-weight models hold OpenRouter's top five usage slots.
5. Tesla reports third-quarter results after today's close, with its webcast at 5:30pm EDT.

On the beat

POSTED · 26

Elon Musk, Clément Delangue, David Heinemeier Hansson, Jim Fan, Uncle Bob Martin, Tim Sweeney, Guillermo Rauch, Paul Graham, Arthur Mensch, Joe Gebbia, Greg Brockman, Alexandr Wang, Tobi Lütke, Satya Nadella, Yann LeCun, Sundar Pichai, Guillaume Lample, Andrej Karpathy, Dario Amodei, Palmer Luckey, Jeff Dean, Sam Altman, Ashok Elluswamy, Aaron Levie, Michael Dell, Mark Chen.

SILENT · 20

Marc Andreessen, Jensen Huang, Demis Hassabis, John Carmack, Patrick Collison, Vitalik Buterin, François Chollet, Fei-Fei Li, Mustafa Suleyman, Andrew Ng, Michael Truell, Tom Brown, Mira Murati, Mark Zuckerberg, Noam Brown, David Singleton, Ilya Sutskever, Lisa Su, Kanjun Qiu, Nat Friedman.

The watch list stands at 46.

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